

MATTHEW GROTE

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cybersecurity professional with 6+ years of experience spanning GRC, cloud security engineering, and enterprise consulting. Proven ability to develop compliance frameworks, conduct risk assessments, and enforce security controls across complex environments — including PNC Bank and Amazon. Deep working knowledge of NIST 800-53, PCI-DSS, and Zero Trust principles. Holds an active CompTIA Security+; MS-Management and Leadership (WGU, exp. 2026). Combines technical hands-on expertise with strong communication and instructional skills to bridge security teams and business stakeholders.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Cybersecurity Engineer | PNC Bank — Remote

March 2025 – September 2025

- Engineered and configured Microsoft Defender for Cloud and Palo Alto Prisma Cloud (CSPM) to continuously monitor thousands of Azure and AWS resources, enabling real-time compliance gap detection aligned to NIST 800-53 and CIS Benchmarks.
- Authored hundreds of RQL queries within Prisma Cloud to implement custom compliance policies, significantly improving detection of misconfigured resources and reducing drift across multi-cloud environments.
- Collaborated cross-functionally on a 10-person core security engineering team to design and maintain enterprise-scale cloud security controls, ensuring audit-ready configurations across Azure and AWS.
- Automated cloud security infrastructure provisioning using Terraform, Jenkins, and IaC platforms — enforcing repeatable, policy-compliant security baselines and reducing manual remediation effort.
- Validated control effectiveness in lower environments and promoted approved configurations to production, ensuring consistent policy enforcement and supporting continuous compliance posture.

Cybersecurity Curriculum Developer | Flatiron School — Remote

June 2024 – February 2025

- Developed comprehensive cybersecurity curriculum integrating GRC, risk management, and compliance frameworks, resulting in a 15% improvement in learner assessment scores within four months.
- Integrated an enterprise LMS platform into cybersecurity course delivery, achieving a 25% increase in learner engagement and a 20% improvement in course completion rates within three months.
- Conducted in-depth training needs analyses to align curriculum with industry frameworks (NIST, PCI-DSS, FERPA), ensuring learning outcomes matched real-world GRC and analyst skill requirements.
- Collaborated with subject-matter experts to continuously review and update content, maintaining accuracy against evolving regulatory requirements and cybersecurity standards.

Lead Consumer Instructor — Cybersecurity Bootcamp | Flatiron School — Remote

January 2024 – June 2024

- Delivered a 15-week Cybersecurity Engineering program covering GRC, Networking, Application Security, Cyber Threat Intelligence, SIEM (Splunk), Cryptography, and Python scripting to working professionals.
- Designed advanced lab scenarios bridging theoretical concepts with practical security operations, producing job-ready analysts with hands-on incident response and compliance investigation skills.

Lead Enterprise Instructor (Amazon) | Flatiron School — Remote

July 2023 – October 2023

- Led enterprise security awareness instruction for Amazon workforce cohorts, facilitating red/blue team tabletop exercises to strengthen incident response capabilities and executive understanding of threat impact.
- Delivered focused modules on data breach risk, regulatory obligations, and organizational response strategies — building compliance awareness at scale across a major enterprise workforce.

Lead Adjunct Instructor — Cybersecurity Bootcamp | ThriveDX — Remote

September 2022 – June 2023

- Served as Adjunct Lecturer for Pennsylvania State University and University of Central Florida cybersecurity bootcamps, translating complex security and GRC concepts into practical, measurable skills for working professionals.

Cybersecurity Consultant | Vital Signs Church Consulting — Hybrid

August 2020 – April 2023

- Implemented new security policies and controls that increased threat detection effectiveness by 30%, reducing organizational risk exposure and establishing a repeatable vulnerability management workflow.
- Managed patch management and disaster recovery planning, ensuring timely remediation of known vulnerabilities and maintaining business continuity readiness across the institution.

Systems Administrator | *Saint Vincent College — Hybrid*

July 2019 – July 2020

- Spearheaded development and implementation of server security procedures using auditing software, reducing compliance issues by 30% within six months and improving alignment with institutional security standards.
- Managed project timelines and security compliance initiatives, ensuring systems remained aligned with audit requirements and applicable regulatory obligations.

PROJECTS

WGU Capstone — Cloud Security Migration Strategy |

- Architected a comprehensive cloud migration plan for a simulated university environment, applying Zero Trust principles, NIST controls, and cloud security best practices to rehabilitate legacy infrastructure.

PowerShell Media Manager (GitHub) |

- Engineered a modular GUI application in PowerShell integrating VLC, MPV, and FFmpeg with a custom media tracking system — demonstrating scripting, automation, and lightweight systems design skills.

EDUCATION

Master of Science – Management and Leadership

Exp. July 2026

Western Governors University

Bachelor of Science – Cybersecurity and Information Assurance

June 2022

Western Governors University

Associate of Applied Science – Information Technology

June 2018

Pierpont Community and Technical College

CERTIFICATIONS

CompTIA Security+ • CompTIA Network+ • CompTIA A+ (Recertified May 2022)

EC-Council Encryption Specialist (ECES) • ITIL Foundation (AXELOS) • Simply-Cyber GRC Analyst

Pursuing: CRISC (Certified in Risk and Information Systems Control) — in progress

TECHNICAL SKILLS

GRC & Compliance	NIST 800-53 Rev 5, PCI-DSS, FERPA, Zero Trust, CISA Framework, Risk Assessment, Gap Analysis, Policy Development, Audit Coordination, Control Implementation, Third-Party Risk
Cloud Security	Microsoft Defender for Cloud, Microsoft Sentinel, Palo Alto Prisma Cloud (CSPM), Azure Security Center, AWS Security Hub, IaC Security (Terraform, Jenkins)
Security Tools	Splunk SIEM, Nmap, Wireshark, Python, PowerShell, VMware ESXi/vSphere, Docker, Proxmox
Frameworks	MITRE ATT&CK, ISO 27001 (familiar), SOC 2 (familiar), CMMC, CIS Benchmarks
Soft Skills	Stakeholder Communication, Executive Reporting, Curriculum Development, Cross-Functional Collaboration, Instructional Design

PROFESSIONAL INVOLVEMENT

- Cybersecurity SME & Career Coach, Trellus — Delivered resume reviews, interview prep, and technical cybersecurity coaching over 6 months.
- Order of the Sword and Shield Honor Society (Omicron Sigma Sigma) — WGU Cybersecurity Club Ambassador.